Level 0 · about 4 h · Python 3.8+

Project: A Hello, me card
Examples run on CPython 3.12.3. **You will be able to:**

- Run a one-line program and read what it printed
- Read an error message from the last line upward
- Find the official docs page for a built-in function
- Explain what a program is in your own words

First Program

What a program is

A program is a list of instructions a computer follows in order. Python reads your file from the top and does each instruction in turn.

Your first print

`print` shows a value on the screen. Text goes inside quotes.

```
print("Hello, me")
print("My first program")
```

```
Output (CPython 3.12.3):
Hello, me
My first program
```

Printing more than text

You can print numbers and do arithmetic. Python works the answer out before it prints.

```
print(2 + 3)
print("2 + 3 =", 2 + 3)
```

```
Output (CPython 3.12.3):
5
2 + 3 = 5
```

Reading an error

An error is not a failure. A traceback is a map: start at the last line, which names the problem. This example catches the error so you can see its message.

```
try:
    print(undefined_name)
except NameError as err:
    print("NameError:", err)
```

```
Output (CPython 3.12.3):
NameError: name 'undefined_name' is not defined
```

Find the docs

Every built-in function has a page in the official documentation. Search for `print()` and read its parameters, such as sep and end.

```
print("a", "b", "c", sep="-")
print("no newline", end="!")
print()
```

```
Output (CPython 3.12.3):
a-b-c
no newline!
```

Check yourself

1. What does `print("2 + 3")` show, compared with `print(2 + 3)`?
2. Which line of a traceback names the problem?
3. What does sep change?

Project: Hello, me card

Print four lines: your name, one thing you are learning, one thing you like, and today's goal. Then change the sep between two items.

Sources

- Python tutorial: An informal introduction
- Python docs: print()
- Python tutorial: Errors and exceptions

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